

GLOBAL SUPERSTORE

Business Intelligence & Performance Report

Fiscal Years 2011 – 2014

\$12.6M
Total Revenue

\$1.47M
Total Profit

25,012
Total Orders

795
Unique Customers

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Tools: MySQL · Excel · Power BI

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of Global Superstore's business performance across four fiscal years (2011–2014), covering over 51,000 transactions, 795 unique customers, and \$12.6 million in total revenue. The analysis leverages MySQL for data querying, Microsoft Excel for pivot-table summaries, and Power BI for interactive dashboards.

Key highlights include consistent year-on-year revenue growth, Technology emerging as the most profitable category, APAC leading all markets in revenue, and Standard Class dominating as the preferred shipping mode. However, over 12,500 orders resulted in negative profit — primarily driven by aggressive discounting in the Furniture category.

Metric	Value	Metric	Value
Total Revenue	\$12,607,914	Total Profit	\$1,465,178
Total Orders	25,012	Unique Customers	795
Profit Margin	11.6%	Avg. Order Value	\$246
Loss-Making Orders	12,518 (24.5%)	Top Market	APAC (\$3.58M)
Best Category	Technology	Top Sub-Category	Copiers

2. Sales Performance Analysis

Revenue grew steadily over all four years, with a **92% increase** from 2011 to 2014 — reflecting strong business expansion. The compound annual growth rate (CAGR) over this period stands at approximately **17.8%**.

Year	Total Sales	YoY Growth	Remarks
2011	\$2,232,261	—	Baseline year
2012	\$2,677,479	+19.9%	Steady growth
2013	\$3,404,254	+27.2%	Accelerated
2014	\$4,293,920	+26.1%	Peak performance

Insight: Sales peaked in 2014, driven by increasing order volumes across the Consumer and Corporate segments. The consistent growth trajectory suggests strong market demand and effective sales strategy execution.

3. Profitability Analysis

Total profit across all years amounts to **\$1,465,178**, yielding an overall profit margin of **11.6%**. Technology is the clear profit leader, while Furniture lags despite generating reasonable sales volume.

Category	Total Profit	% of Total	Analysis
Technology	\$663,434	45.3%	Highest margin; premium products
Office Supplies	\$517,544	35.3%	High volume; consistent performer
Furniture	\$284,200	19.4%	Low margin; discount-heavy

Key Observation: Furniture generates significant sales but shows the lowest profitability due to high discounting (max discount: 85%) and elevated shipping costs for bulky items. Reducing discounts in Furniture could substantially improve margins.

4. Market & Regional Insights

Global Superstore operates across 7 major markets. APAC leads with the highest revenue share, followed by EU and US. The Central region is the top-performing region globally.

Market	Revenue	Share	Notes
APAC	\$3,576,349	28.4%	#1 — Largest market
EU	\$2,929,329	23.2%	#2 — Strong European presence
US	\$2,290,504	18.2%	#3 — Domestic market
LATAM	\$2,156,827	17.1%	#4 — Growing market
EMEA	\$804,701	6.4%	Mid-tier performer
Africa	\$783,272	6.2%	Emerging market
Canada	\$66,932	0.5%	Smallest market

Region	Total Sales
Central	\$2,813,186
South	\$1,595,289
North	\$1,246,141
Oceania	\$1,094,632
Southeast Asia	\$883,307
North Asia	\$846,351
EMEA	\$804,701
Africa	\$783,272

Insight: Canada remains significantly underpenetrated at just 0.5% of revenue. A targeted go-to-market strategy for Canada and Africa could unlock meaningful growth opportunities.

5. Customer & Segment Analysis

The Consumer segment contributes the majority of sales at **51.5%**. Top customers account for a disproportionate share of revenue, highlighting concentration risk.

Segment	Sales	Profit	Sales %	Margin
Consumer	\$6,488,653	\$748,969	51.5%	11.5%
Corporate	\$3,814,278	\$439,763	30.2%	11.5%

Home Office	\$2,304,983	\$276,446	18.3%	12.0%
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Top 5 Customers by Sales:

Customer Name	Total Sales
Tom Ashbrook	\$40,489
Tamara Chand	\$37,453
Greg Tran	\$35,552
Christopher Conant	\$35,187
Sean Miller	\$35,131

6. Product & Sub-Category Performance

Sub-Category	Total Profit	Category	Analysis
Copiers	\$257,527	Technology	Highest profit contributor
Phones	\$217,098	Technology	High volume + high margin
Bookcases	\$160,460	Furniture	Best furniture sub-category
Appliances	\$141,681	Office Supplies	Steady performer
Chairs	\$141,194	Furniture	Volume-driven
Accessories	\$129,461	Technology	High-frequency low-ticket
Storage	\$108,215	Office Supplies	Consistent demand
Binders	\$72,147	Office Supplies	High order count
Machines	\$59,348	Technology	Mid-range
Paper	\$59,104	Office Supplies	Commodity product

Top 10 Products by Profit:

Product Name	Total Profit
Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	\$25,200
Cisco Smart Phone, Full Size	\$17,239
Motorola Smart Phone, Full Size	\$17,027
Hoover Stove, Red	\$11,808
Sauder Classic Bookcase, Traditional	\$10,672
Harbour Creations Executive Leather Armchair	\$10,427
Nokia Smart Phone, Full Size	\$9,938
Cisco Smart Phone, with Caller ID	\$9,787
Nokia Smart Phone, with Caller ID	\$9,465

Belkin Router, USB	\$8,955
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7. Discount & Loss Analysis

A total of **12,518 orders (24.5%)** generated negative profit. Heavy discounting — particularly in Furniture — is the primary driver. The average discount rate across all orders is **14.3%**, with Furniture receiving the highest maximum discount of **85%**.

Category	Max Discount	Observations
Furniture	85%	Highest — major profit leak
Office Supplies	80%	High volume; risk of loss at extremes
Technology	45%	Lower discounts; better margins

Recommendation: Implement discount guardrails — cap Furniture discounts at 30% and require management approval for discounts exceeding 40% in any category. This alone could recover an estimated \$200K+ in annual profit.

8. Shipping & Operations

Standard Class is the dominant shipping mode, used for nearly **60%** of all orders. Same Day delivery remains a premium, low-volume option at just 5.2% of orders.

Ship Mode	Orders	Share	Notes
Standard Class	30,717	59.6%	Most cost-effective
Second Class	10,286	19.9%	Mid-speed option
First Class	7,494	14.5%	Premium standard
Same Day	2,695	5.2%	Urgent / high-priority
Total	51,192	100%	

Insight: The high utilisation of Standard Class indicates customers are not typically time-sensitive. There is an opportunity to upsell First Class and Same Day for high-value orders to improve revenue per shipment.

9. SQL Analysis Insights

The following insights were derived from MySQL queries run against the dataset containing 51,192 transaction records in the *employee* database:

1	Highest Revenue Market APAC generated the highest revenue (\$3.58M) among all markets, followed by EU (\$2.93M) and US (\$2.29M).
2	Least Profitable Category Furniture showed significantly lower profitability (\$284K) versus Technology (\$663K) and Office Supplies (\$518K), largely due to high discounting.

3	Most Common Shipping Mode Standard Class was used in 59.6% of all orders — the most frequently chosen shipping option by far.
4	Top Performing Products Technology products — particularly copiers and smartphones — contributed the highest individual product profit figures.
5	Loss-Making Orders 12,518 orders (24.5%) produced negative profit, primarily caused by discount levels exceeding product margins.
6	Monthly Sales Trend Sales performance fluctuated across months with Q4 consistently showing peak sales, driven by end-of-year purchasing cycles.
7	Region-wise Sales Central (\$2.81M) and South (\$1.60M) were the two top-performing regions; Canada (\$67K) was the weakest.
8	Discount Analysis Furniture received the highest maximum discounts (up to 85%), directly correlating with its low profit margin.
9	Customer Analysis Top 5 customers — led by Tom Ashbrook (\$40.5K) — contributed a disproportionately large share of total revenue.
10	Sub-Category Performance Copiers (\$257.5K profit) and Phones (\$217.1K) led all sub-categories, while Tables and Bookcases showed mixed results.

10. Strategic Recommendations

1. Discount Control Policy

Implement a tiered discount approval framework. Cap Furniture discounts at 30% and require VP-level approval for any discount above 40% across all categories. Estimated profit recovery: \$200K+/year.

2. Technology Category Expansion

Increase investment in Technology — the highest-margin category (45.3% of total profit). Expand SKU range in Copiers, Phones, and Accessories for APAC and EU markets.

3. Canada Market Development

Canada contributes only 0.5% of revenue. A dedicated regional sales team and localised pricing strategy could unlock significant untapped potential.

4. Customer Retention Programme

The top 5 customers contribute over \$183K in sales. Introduce a loyalty/key-account management programme to protect and grow revenue from high-value customers.

5. Shipping Upsell Strategy

Standard Class dominates at 59.6%. Introduce incentives for high-value orders to upgrade to First Class or Same Day, improving both revenue per order and customer experience.

6. Furniture Profitability Review

Audit the Furniture sub-category product-by-product. Consider discontinuing or repricing consistently loss-making SKUs to improve category-level margins.

7. Q4 Sales Capitalisation

Sales peak in Q4. Pre-position inventory, increase marketing spend, and offer strategic promotions in Q3 to capture early holiday demand and smoothen revenue seasonality.